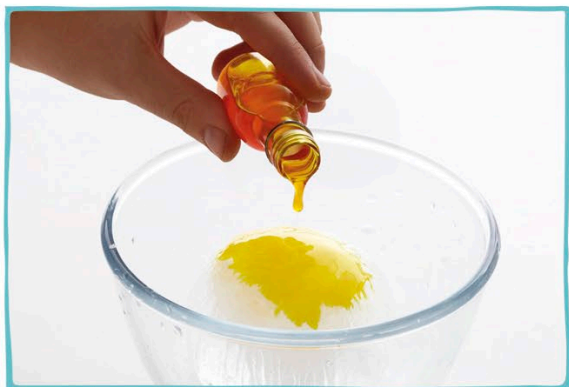




3 Put your ball of ice back in a bowl or on a tray. Sprinkle a little salt on top of the ice ball. Watch the ice melt where the salt grains land, peppering the icy surface with lots of tiny holes.



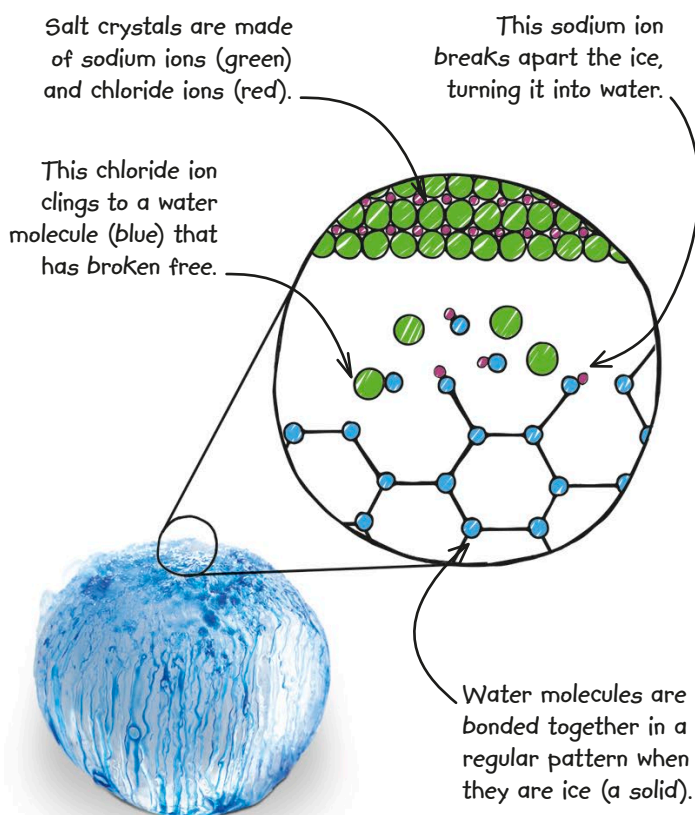
4 Drip some food coloring onto the ice. The coloring will mostly sit on top of the solid ice, but it will quickly dissolve in the melted ice to make colored rivers that stream down the side.

5 To make your icy creation look even more beautiful, add different food colorings. And if you shine a flashlight or lamp under one of your icy creations, you can get a really spectacular effect!

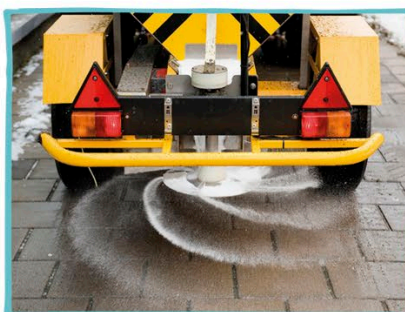


HOW IT WORKS

Salt grains are crystals, and are made of two types of particle—sodium ions and chloride ions—joined together. When salt is sprinkled on an icy orb, the ions break up the regular arrangement of water molecules in the ice. Once the water molecules are broken apart, the ice becomes liquid. Since sodium and chloride ions attach to the water molecules, the water molecules cannot bond together unless the temperature becomes very cold again.



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water from turning into ice. This is because adding salt lowers the freezing point of water.

In freezing temperatures, specially designed trucks spread salt spread on major roads and sidewalks to prevent accidents. The salt melts any snow or ice that is already on these surfaces, and also prevents